

Code of Conduct

Code of Ethics

As professionals, we need to understand the code of ethics. I have presented the two most relevant organizations' codes of ethics here. As ICT graduates most students prefer to get professional association membership with the Australian Computer Society. Some others (mostly software engineering majors) often prefer getting the Engineers Australia membership.

Australian Computer Society Code of Ethics:

The following code of ethics applies to all ACS members regardless of their specific ICT role:

1. **The Primacy of the Public Interest** You will place the interests of the public above those of personal, business or sectional interests.
2. **The Enhancement of Quality of Life** You will strive to enhance the quality of life of those affected by your work.
3. **Honesty** You will be honest in your representation of skills, knowledge, services and products.
4. **Competence** You will work competently and diligently for your stakeholders.
5. **Professional Development** You will enhance your own professional development, and that of your colleagues and staff.
6. **Professionalism** You will enhance the integrity of the Society and the respect of its members for each other.

Here is a reference to the source document: [ACS code of Ethics \(https://www.acs.org.au/content/dam/acs/acs-documents/Code-of-Ethics.pdf\)](https://www.acs.org.au/content/dam/acs/acs-documents/Code-of-Ethics.pdf)

Engineering Australia Code of Ethics:

In engineering practice, professionals will practice the following:

1. **Demonstrate integrity**
 - Act on the basis of a well-informed conscience
 - Be honest and trustworthy
 - Respect the dignity of all persons
2. **Practice competently**
 - Maintain and develop knowledge and skills
 - Represent areas of competence objectively

- Act on the basis of adequate knowledge

3. Exercise leadership

- Uphold the reputation and trustworthiness of the practice of engineering
- Support and encourage diversity
- Communicate honestly and effectively, taking into account the reliance of others on engineering expertise

4. Promote sustainability

- Engage responsibly with the community and other stakeholders
- Practise engineering to foster the health, safety and wellbeing of the community and the environment
- Balance the needs of the present with the needs of future generations

More details are available from the source document [EA code of ethics \(https://www.engineersaustralia.org.au/publications/code-ethics\)](https://www.engineersaustralia.org.au/publications/code-ethics)

Laws and Policies:

Cybercrime Act (2001)

This act is designed (following Commonwealth Cybercrime Bill 2001), to put regulations for computer and internet related offenses. The act comprised of two major schedules. An amendment done in 2012 Cybercrime Legislation Amendment Act 2012 is comprised of in five schedules.

Cybercrime Act (2001) Schedule 1:

- Unauthorised access to or modification of data stored in a computer with intent to commit a serious offence.
- Unauthorised impairment of electronic communication to or from a computer with intent to commit a serious offence.
- Unauthorised modification of data to cause impairment.
- Unauthorised impairment of an electronic communication.
- Unauthorised access to, or modification of restricted data (ie, data protected by a password or other security feature), where the restricted data is either held for or on behalf of the Commonwealth or the access to or modification of it is caused by means of a telecommunications service.
- Unauthorised impairment of data held on a computer disk etc.
- Possession or control of data with intent to commit a computer offence.
- Producing, supplying or obtaining data with intent to commit a computer offence.

Cybercrime Act (2001) Schedule 2:

- equipment found at premises to be moved to another place for examination if there are reasonable grounds to believe that it contains or constitutes evidential material and it is practicable to do so
- executing officers to operate electronic equipment and copy data to a disk, tape or other associated device if they believe on reasonable grounds that the equipment may constitute evidential material
- an order to be obtained from a magistrate requiring a specified person to provide the information and assistance that is reasonable and necessary for an officer to access, copy and convert data found in computers into documentary form, and
- executing officers to access via computer, data that is not physically at the warrant premises.

Read the **Cybercrime Act 2001** (<https://www.legislation.gov.au/Details/C2004C01213>) (Federal Register of Legislation, 2001).

Read the **Cybercrime Legislation Amendment Act 2012** (<https://www.legislation.gov.au/Details/C2012A00120>) (Federal Register of Legislation, 2012).

Australian Privacy Principles

The Australian Privacy Principle (APP) protects personal information- information or an opinion about an identified individual or indication to an individual who is reasonably identifiable.

The Privacy Act contains exemptions for certain organisations from the requirement to comply with the APPs such as - operators of small businesses (businesses with an annual turnover for the previous financial year of A\$3 million or less), domestic use, media organisations and political representatives. There is no general exemption for not-for-profit organisations.

There are 13 principles:

APP 1: Open and transparent management of personal information

APP 2: Anonymity and pseudonymity

APP 3: Collection of solicited personal information

APP 4: Unsolicited personal information

APP 5: Notification of collecting personal information

APP 6: Uses or disclosures of personal information

APP 7: Direct marketing

APP 8: Cross-border disclosure of personal information

APP 9: Adoption, use or disclosure of government-related identifiers

APP 10: Quality of personal information

APP 11: Security of personal information

APP 12: Access to personal information

APP 13: Correction of personal information

More can be found [here. \(https://www.oaic.gov.au/privacy/australian-privacy-principles\)](https://www.oaic.gov.au/privacy/australian-privacy-principles)



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